

Shhh! France's President Tells a Whole Room to Be Quiet

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Have you ever been in a room where everyone is chatting so loudly that nobody can hear the speaker? That's what happened at a big meeting in Nairobi, Kenya, but the speaker was the president of France!

President Emmanuel Macron was at the Africa Forward **summit**, where leaders from more than 30 African countries, business people, and young **entrepreneurs** were talking about working together. But while someone was speaking on stage, the audience kept having their own conversations. Macron got so **frustrated** that he **interrupted** the speaker to tell everyone to be quiet.

"There is a total lack of respect," Macron said. He told people that if they wanted to keep talking, they should go outside or find a meeting room. The French leader is in Kenya to strengthen friendships and business ties between France and African countries.

The **summit** was a big deal, but the noise made it hard to focus. Imagine if you were giving a presentation in class and your classmates wouldn't stop whispering you'd probably want the teacher to step in. That's basically what Macron did, except he's the president!

The rest of the news that day was full of other stories like a **ceasefire** between the US and Iran, a missing American pilot, and a plan for a **detention** center in Georgia. But the moment everyone was talking about was a president shushing a room full of grown-ups.

Word Treasure

summit -- A very important meeting where leaders or experts gather to talk about big topics.

entrepreneurs -- People who start their own businesses and take risks to try new ideas.

frustrated -- Feeling annoyed or upset because things are not going the way you want.

interrupted -- Stopped someone from speaking by breaking in with words or actions before they were finished.

ceasefire -- An agreement between groups to stop fighting for a period of time.

detention -- Keeping someone in an official place, like a special center, often when they are not allowed to leave.

Background you need

President Emmanuel Macron (the leader of France) was at a big meeting in Nairobi, the capital city of Kenya, where African and international leaders talk about working together.

Summits like Africa Forward bring together governments and young business starters to discuss ideas, but side conversations can make it hard for everyone to listen and learn.

France has a long history with many African countries, and today it tries to build friendly business and cultural connections there.

Break it down

WHO: President Emmanuel Macron of France

WHAT: Interrupted the meeting to scold a noisy crowd for being disrespectful

WHERE: At the Africa Forward summit in Nairobi, Kenya

WHY: He was frustrated because the audience kept chatting while the speaker was talking, and he felt it showed a lack of respect

Why it matters

Just like in a classroom, if everyone talks while someone is presenting, nothing gets learned--important meetings need quiet attention so countries can solve problems together.

Test what you remember

1. Who told the audience to be quiet at the Africa Forward summit?

- ☐ (A) A business leader
- ☐ (B) The president of Kenya
- ☐ (C) The president of France
- ☐ (D) A young entrepreneur

2. Why did Macron interrupt the speaker?

- ☐ (A) The speaker said something wrong
- ☐ (B) The microphone stopped working
- ☐ (C) The audience was talking loudly
- ☐ (D) He had a more important speech

3. In which city did the summit take place?

- ☐ (A) Paris
- ☐ (B) Nairobi
- ☐ (C) Cairo
- ☐ (D) Lagos

4. What did Macron say the audience showed?

- ☐ (A) Great excitement
- ☐ (B) A total lack of respect
- ☐ (C) Good teamwork
- ☐ (D) Deep knowledge

5. Why was Macron in Kenya?

- ☐ (A) To go on a safari holiday
- ☐ (B) To strengthen friendships and business ties with African countries
- ☐ (C) To sign a ceasefire agreement
- ☐ (D) To build a detention center

6. What other event was mentioned alongside this story?

- ☐ (A) A ceasefire between the US and Iran
- ☐ (B) A school opening in Georgia
- ☐ (C) A new gold discovery in India
- ☐ (D) A French music concert

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: B 4: B 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Supportive:** Some people think Macron did the right thing by insisting on respect, which helps important meetings work properly.
2. **Critical:** Others feel that shaming grown-ups publicly was rude and could damage friendships between France and African partners.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):